

# Wide Elements Between Column Bands

Dana Filler  
Laboratory of Sample Layouts

## Abstract

Some journals place wide figures, tables and equations in the middle of a page, with two columns of text above them and two more below. A reader finishes both upper columns before looking at the wide element, and only then continues with the lower columns.

## 1 Background

Columns in the upper band are short, because the wide figure that follows them takes up the middle of the page. The left column of this band ends with this sentence.

The right column of the upper band continues the argument. It must be read after the left column of the same band, but before the caption of the figure below it.

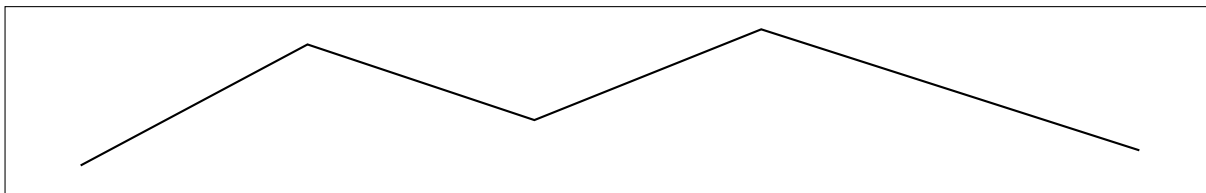


Figure 1: A wide figure placed between two bands of columns. Its caption spans the full width of the text block.

## 2 Observations

The lower band starts again in the left column, directly below the wide figure. A reader who sorted the page by column alone would jump here too early, straight after the upper left column.

The right column of the lower band is the last text on the first page. Anything that follows belongs to the next page of the document.

### 3 A wide equation

Displayed material that is too long for one column is often set across the full width, splitting the columns above and below it in the same way as a wide figure does.

The same rule applies: finish both columns above the display, read the display, then continue in the left column underneath it.

$$\Phi(x) = \sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i \exp\left(-\frac{(x - \mu_i)^2}{2\sigma_i^2}\right) + \sum_{j=1}^m \beta_j \cos(\omega_j x + \varphi_j) + \gamma x^2 + \delta \quad (1)$$

### 4 Closing remarks

Mid-page wide elements are less common than wide floats at the top of a page, but they appear in several journal styles.

A full-width paragraph may also close the page, as the acknowledgement below does.

**Acknowledgements.** This full-width paragraph follows both columns of the lower band and is read last on the page.